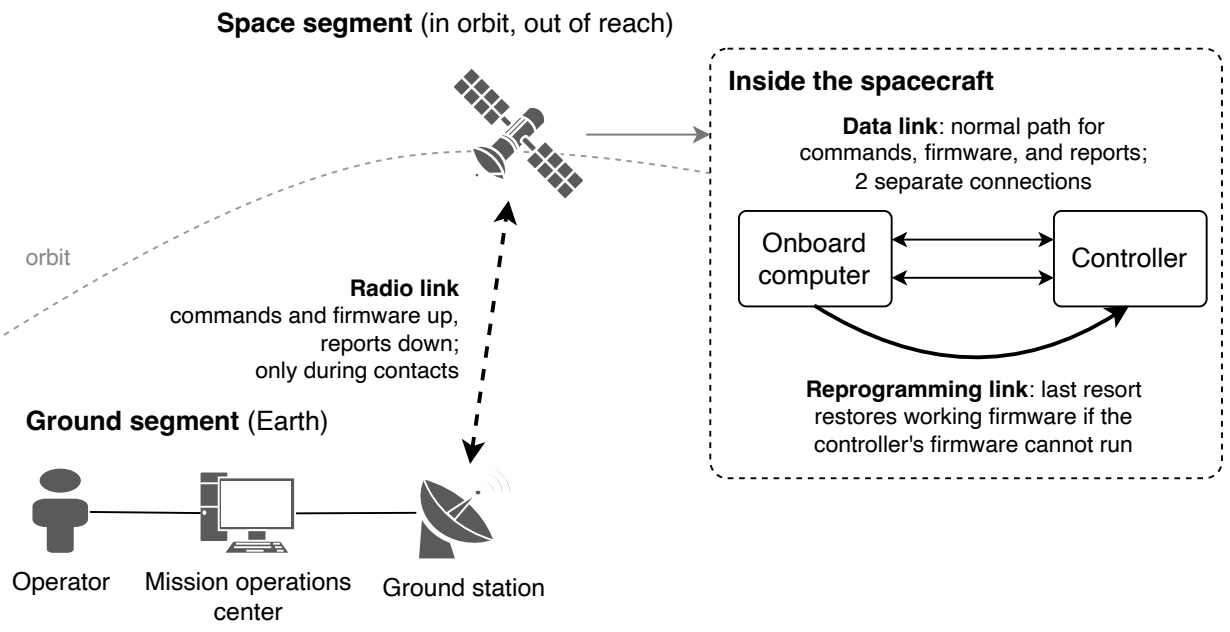
**Space segment** (in orbit, out of reach)
orbit
**Radio link**
commands and firmware up,
reports down;
only during contacts
**Ground segment** (Earth)
Operator
Mission operations center
Ground station
**Inside the spacecraft**
**Data link**: normal path for commands, firmware, and reports; 2 separate connections
Onboard computer
Controller
**Reprogramming link**: last resort restores working firmware if the controller's firmware cannot run